CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 1

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Source: 'Two of every three sultans came to the throne by removing the previous one.' This suggests that the Sultanate 1

(a) lacked orderly succession **(b)** had no sultans
(c) was very stable **(d)** was elective

2. Source: 'Forts are the foundation of the kingdom.' A king who says this probably depends on 1

(a) open-plain wars **(b)** defence of strategic places
(c) no army **(d)** sea trade only

3. Source: 'The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India.' The speaker refers to 1

(a) a festival **(b)** a battle
(c) a flood **(d)** collapse of the textile industry

4. Which can be inferred from the paik system? 1

(a) No army **(b)** Wages in cash
(c) Free education **(d)** State relied on labour service for land

5. The Marathas' confrontation with the British is explained by 1

(a) trade only **(b)** British seeing them as the main rival
(c) no contact **(d)** British friendship

6. Planters forcing peasants to grow indigo at low rates leads to 1

(a) wealth **(b)** debt and revolt **(c)** peace **(d)** prosperity

7. Which statement reflects a balanced view of Aurangzeb? 1

(a) He expanded the empire but strained its finances and harmony
(b) He was Akbar's son
(c) He was a failure in everything
(d) He was perfect

8. The significance of the cultural revival under Shivaji was 1

(a) local language and identity **(b)** ban
(c) foreign adoption **(d)** end of language

9. If the Governor-General annexes a state by saying it is badly governed, he uses 1

(a) Lapse **(b)** Cartaz
(c) the charge of misrule **(d)** Subsidiary only

10. A coin of base metal is declared equal to a silver coin. After some months silver coins disappear from the market. This is explained by 1

(a) silver becoming cheap
(b) royal gift
(c) trade rising
(d) people hoarding silver and forging copies

11. If an official's post is hereditary, the likely risk to the ruler is 1

(a) lower taxes **(b)** more trade
(c) faster travel **(d)** growth of independent power

12. A ruler dies with no natural son but has adopted one. Under Lapse the British would 1

(a) recognise the heir **(b)** give gold
(c) leave it **(d)** annex the state

13. **Assertion (A):** The Delhi Sultanate is said to have begun after Prithviraj Chauhan's defeat in 1192. 1

Reason (R): Muhammad of Ghor defeated Prithviraj Chauhan at the Second Battle of Tarain.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** Shivaji built a navy for the Marathas. 1

Reason (R): A navy was needed to secure the west coast.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** The Portuguese captured Goa in 1510 under Albuquerque. 1

Reason (R): Vasco da Gama had reached Kappad near Kozhikode in 1498.
Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. 'Two of every three sultans removed their predecessors.' What does this show? 2

17. Why did Shivaji not allow cutting of mango and jackfruit trees? 2

18. 'Bones of cotton weavers' remark: what does it tell about the economy? 2

19. What does Krishnadevaraya's Amuktamalyada tell us about him? 2

20. What does the Treaty of Purandar tell us about Shivaji's leadership? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Source: 'The new coins are made of copper but must be accepted as silver.' Identify the ruler and explain the result. 3

22. Source: 'Forts are the core of the state; ships are the sea forts' (Adnyapatra idea). Explain what the writer says about Maratha defence. 3

23. Source: 'India's share in world GDP fell from one-fourth to about 5 per cent.' Give three causes. 3

24. Case: A temple has a chariot design and records the king's victories. Explain what this tells about the age. 3

OR

Analyse why the Marathas could not hold north India after Panipat. 3

25. Compare the strategies of Dupleix and Clive. 3

OR

Examine why Vijayanagara's wealth made it a target. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** A sultan of the Tughlaq dynasty moved his capital from Delhi to Daulatabad, the former Devagiri, hoping to rule the south better. Later he issued token coins of cheap metal and declared them equal in value to silver. Many people forged the coins at home, and traders refused to accept them. 5

(i) To which place was the capital shifted?

(ii) Name the sultan.

(iii) Why did the token currency fail?

(iv) Give two lessons that rulers can learn from these experiments.

27. Source: 'The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India.' 5

(i) Who said it?

(ii) Explain the causes.

(iii) Describe the effects on weavers and towns.

OR

Discuss how trade, ports and credit instruments such as hundis supported medieval kingdoms. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks